PRESENCE GUARD / WINDOWS & OBS STUDIO

Usage guide

Keep your stream on a safe scene when you step away or the microphone goes quiet.

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Watch
Activity & audio

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02
Switch
A safe scene

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Restore
Your live scene

A little protection for your live scene

Presence Guard watches for idle input and, optionally, sustained low microphone levels. It remembers the scene it changed from and can restore it when the condition clears.

Inside this guide

Enable and test the AFK rule, configure optional dead-air monitoring, and solve common setup issues.

A practical guide by Emmanuel Suah

Presence Guard is a separate OBS plugin. This guide does not install ScreenForge or its mouse-click rings.

Set up the AFK rule

First install the plugin using the companion installation guide. The OBS 33.x compatibility of the current binary has not been verified.

01 ## Prepare a safe scene

In OBS, create a scene such as **BRB**. Open **Docks > Presence Guard**.

02 ## Enable the guard

Tick **Enable Presence Guard**. Controls remain greyed out while it is off. Changes apply immediately; there is no Save button.

03 ## Choose the scene and delay

Under **AFK rule**, set **Show scene** to your BRB scene. Set **After idle for** to a delay from 10 to 3,600 seconds; the default is 120 seconds.

04 ## Choose when it may act

Keep **Only act while streaming or recording** enabled for normal use. Temporarily untick it if you want to test while offline.

What happens when you return

After the idle threshold, the guard switches to your selected scene. Keyboard or mouse activity clears AFK and restores the previous scene. If you manually choose a different scene while it is parked, the guard leaves your choice alone.

Test before going live

01 Refresh the lists

Click **Refresh** after adding or renaming a scene or audio source. Make sure an AFK scene is selected and the guard is enabled.

02 Test the scene switch

For an offline test, untick **Only act while streaming or recording**. Click **Test AFK** to switch to the AFK scene immediately.

03 Restore and re-arm

Click **Restore now** to return. The manual test stays parked until you restore it. Re-enable **Only act while streaming or recording** if that is how you want to use it.

Read the status line

Watching means the guard is monitoring; **AFK** or **Dead air** means it has switched scenes. **Guard is off** means Enable Presence Guard is unticked. A missing-microphone message means the audio rule is suspended.

Important limits

The automatic rules do not act in OBS Studio Mode. If a selected scene is removed or renamed, choose it again and refresh. If it changed scenes and streaming or recording stops while the live-only gate is enabled, it restores the previous scene.

Add the dead-air rule

01 Enable and pick a microphone

Tick **Dead-air rule**. Select a **Microphone** source that is active in the live scene. Choose a **Show scene** destination, or use **(same as AFK scene)**.

02 Set the delay and threshold

After silence for defaults to 45 seconds (range 5-1,800). **Speech threshold** defaults to -45 dB (range -90 to 0 dB).

03 Tune using your own voice

Speak normally and observe the moving microphone level in the status line. Set the threshold a few dB below your normal speech level. A level at or above the threshold counts as speech.

04 Check the behavior

When measured audio remains below the threshold for the selected time, the guard switches to the configured scene. When the level reaches the threshold again, it restores the previous scene.

No signal is not assumed to be silence

If the selected microphone is muted, disconnected, absent from the live scene, or producing no meter data, the dead-air rule is suspended instead of inventing a silence reading. Check the source and the status line first.

Quick reference

Nothing happens

Enable the guard, select an existing scene, turn off Studio Mode, and check the live-only gate. For dead air, select an active microphone and confirm the level is moving.

It switches too quickly

Increase the idle or silence delay. If the dead-air rule misreads your speech, observe your normal level and adjust the speech threshold a few dB below it.

It does not return

Try **Restore now**. The guard cannot restore a scene that has been deleted, and it does not override a scene that you selected manually while parked.

Your settings

Settings are saved as you edit in the OBS profile **basic.ini**, under **[PresenceGuard]**. Deleting that section resets the plugin settings. Back up the profile before editing it.

For installation, missing-dock, or binary compatibility help, see the companion **Presence Guard installation guide**.

Repository: github.com/lifeemotorola/presence-guard